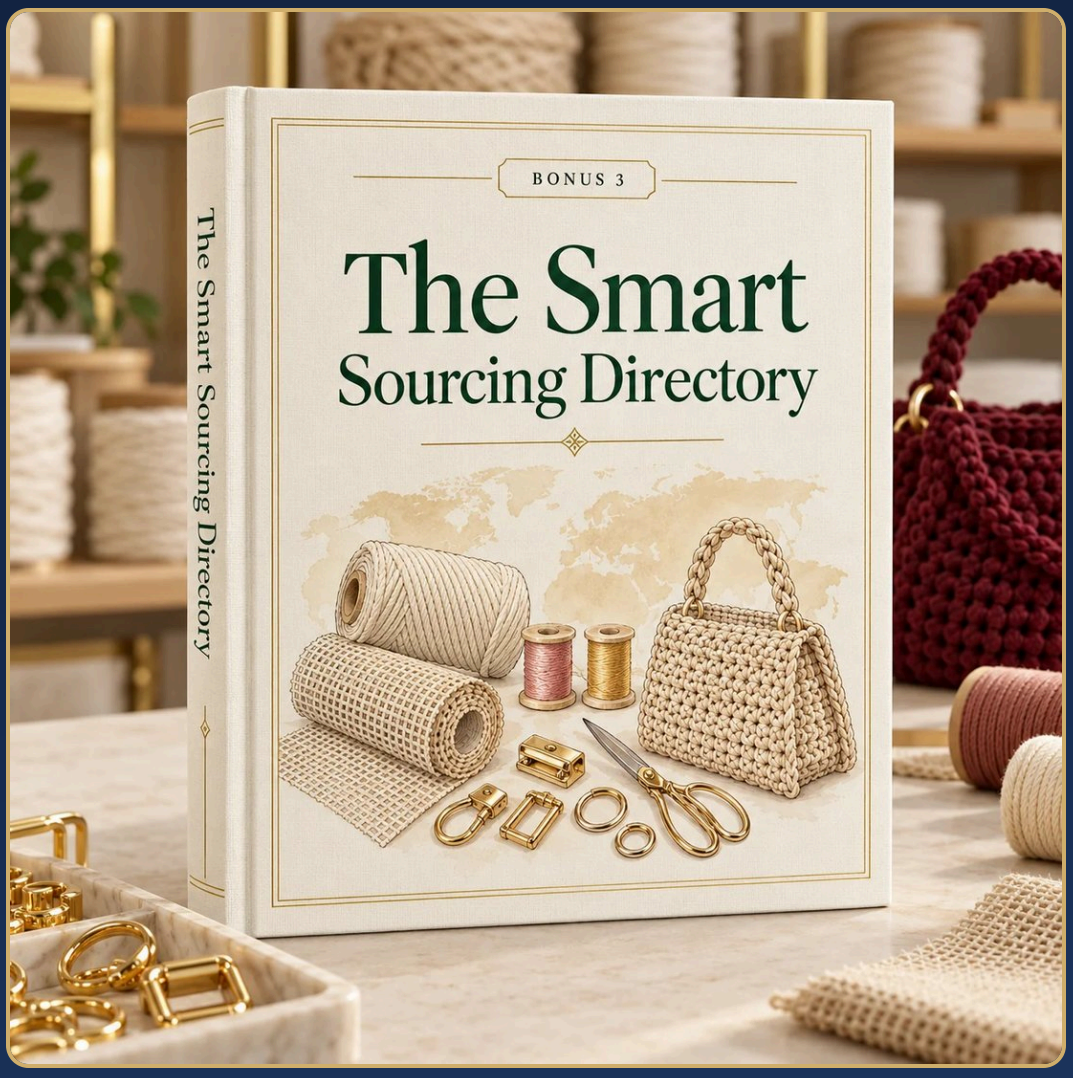
BONUS 3 OF 5

The Smart Sourcing Directory

Where to buy your materials at the best price, wherever you live



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> *The types of suppliers and platforms where you get your materials at the best price, wherever you live in the world.*

Start Here: Save Money Without Losing Quality

Your bags will look expensive because of how you stitch them, not because you paid a lot for supplies. Still, a few materials really do matter. A weak canvas sags. A flimsy chain bends. A cheap glue leaves yellow spots.

This guide shows you where to look for each material, what to check before you buy, and how to keep the total near the $5 per small bag that The Riviera Method is built around. You will not find shop addresses here. Stores open and close all the time, so we focus on **types of places** that exist almost everywhere.

> **The golden rule**
>
> Spend your money where the bag is seen and touched most: the canvas, the yarn and the hardware. Save money on everything hidden, like lining fabric and glue quantities.

> **Please note**
>
> Availability changes: check what is open near you. Every price in this guide is a rough range ('around $X to $Y') and prices vary by country, season and shop. Use them to compare, not as promises.

The Five Types of Suppliers

TYPE OF PLACE	BEST FOR	WATCH OUT FOR
Large craft stores	Canvas sheets, yarn, needles, glue in one trip; coupons and seasonal sales	Full shelf prices if you buy without a coupon
Discount and dollar stores	Cheap felt, glue, small tools, basic hardware	Stock changes weekly; quality varies, so test one first
Online marketplaces	Hardware, chains and bulk lots; the widest choice	Shipping time, photos that do not match, hidden shipping costs
Small wholesalers and bulk sellers	Lower price per piece when you buy packs	Minimum orders; share with friends to reach them

TYPE OF PLACE	BEST FOR	WATCH OUT FOR
Second-hand and recycling	Old bags for hardware, leftover yarn, fabric scraps	You must check condition and sort what is usable

1. Plastic Canvas (7-Count)

What to look for

- **7-count**, meaning 7 holes per inch. This is the size every pattern in the book uses.
- Sheets about 10.5 × 13.5 inches are common. Larger sheets (about 13 × 22 inches) cut down on joins for big bags.
- Stiff, even plastic with square holes and no thin, wobbly bars.
- Clear or white canvas for light yarn, and darker canvas if you want to hide small gaps.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** the easiest place to find true 7-count in several colors. Watch for weekly coupons.
- **Discount stores:** sometimes sell thin canvas cheaply. Good for practice swatches, not for your best bag.
- **Online marketplaces:** multi-packs of sheets bring the price per sheet down a lot. Always check the listing says 7-count.
- **Small wholesalers:** school and craft suppliers often sell bundles of 25 or more.
- **Second-hand:** old craft kits and tissue box covers are a hidden source. Check that the plastic is not cracked or brittle.

Saving tips

- A single sheet usually costs around $0.50 to $1.50 depending on size and shop. A pack lowers that.
- Plan your cuts on paper first so you waste less. Keep every leftover strip for handles, bases and gussets.
- Buy one sheet to test before ordering a big pack from a new seller.

2. Worsted Acrylic Yarn

What to look for

- Worsted weight, 4-ply, 100% acrylic. It covers 7-count canvas well and does not fade easily.
- Smooth, tightly spun yarn. Fuzzy or loosely twisted yarn pills and thins out as you stitch.
- Skeins of about 7 oz (roughly 350 yards) are the best value for most bags.

- Same dye lot for each bag, so one color does not change halfway across a bag.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** wide color ranges, plus house brands that are cheaper than name brands with almost the same quality.
- **Discount stores:** fine for basic colors. Squeeze the skein and look for even thickness.
- **Online marketplaces:** big cone or multi-skein lots are cheap per ounce. Read reviews about color accuracy.
- **Small wholesalers:** yarn sold by weight is often the cheapest way to buy.
- **Second-hand:** half-used skeins from relatives, thrift stores and community groups cost almost nothing.

Saving tips

- A small bag uses only a few ounces of yarn, so a big skein can cover several bags.
- Stripes and patterns use small amounts of many colors. Leftovers are perfect for this.
- Save the paper label of each skein. You will need it to rebuy a matching color.

3. Tapestry Needles

What to look for

- Size 16 or 18 blunt-tip tapestry needles work for worsted yarn on 7-count canvas.
- A large, smooth eye so the yarn threads quickly and does not fray.
- Blunt tips only. A sharp tip splits the canvas threads and your yarn.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** needle packs in the sewing or needlepoint aisle, often around $2 to $5.
- **Discount stores:** sewing kits sometimes include a usable tapestry needle.
- **Online marketplaces:** packs of 20 to 50 mixed needles are cheap and last for years.
- **Second-hand:** old sewing tins are full of needles. Wipe each one and check it is not bent or rusty.

Saving tips

Needles are the cheapest item on your list, so buy a small pack and keep spares in every bag you carry. A bent needle is easy to lose and annoying to replace in the middle of an afternoon project.

4. Bag Chains and Handles

What to look for

- Chain with flat, welded links that look smooth. Open, uneven links snag and pull apart.
- A clip or ring at each end that closes properly. Test it before you buy if you are in a store.
- Weight that suits the bag. A heavy chain can bend a small canvas bag, so use lighter chains on small models.
- Metal that does not flake. Plated chains can peel, so look at reviews with photos after a few weeks of use.
- Handles with a loop or hole you can sew or thread through the canvas edge.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** a small selection of chains by the foot, plus handles in the jewelry or bag-making aisle.
- **Online marketplaces:** the widest choice and the lowest price per foot. Buy a longer length and cut it to fit.
- **Small wholesalers:** bag-making and jewelry suppliers sell chain by the yard, often much cheaper than packaged lengths.
- **Second-hand:** old purses, belts and necklaces are a free source of good chain.

Saving tips

- Chain is usually priced per foot or per yard. A shoulder-strap length of around 24 to 48 inches can cost only a few dollars.
- Buy one length and cut it into shorter straps for several small bags.
- Ask yourself if the bag really needs metal. Stitched canvas straps cost almost nothing.

5. Clasps, Twist Locks and Rings

What to look for

- Twist locks and magnetic snaps that open and close firmly with a small click.
- Flat prongs that are long enough to go through two layers of canvas and still bend over.
- Matching metal color across the whole bag: all gold-tone or all silver-tone.
- D-rings and O-rings that are welded or solid, not split rings that can open under weight.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** a small range in the bag-making or leather section. Good for a quick fix when you run out.

- **Online marketplaces:** sets of 10 to 50 clasps, rings and snaps cost far less per piece. Check the size in inches in the listing.
- **Small wholesalers:** hardware sellers for bag makers offer sets in matching finishes.
- **Second-hand:** old handbags and wallets have clasps and rings you can reuse. This is the cheapest option of all.

Saving tips

- Buy hardware in one finish so everything matches across your bags.
- A simple magnetic snap often looks as polished as a twist lock and costs less.
- Keep spare rings. They are small and easy to lose.

6. Felt and Lining Fabric

What to look for

- Felt that feels dense and does not show light through when held up. Thin felt wrinkles under glue.
- Sheets about 9 × 12 inches for small bags, or felt sold by the yard for bigger bags.
- Fabric scraps in cotton, satin or lining weight that do not fray too much at the edge.
- Colors that match or contrast with the outside yarn on purpose.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** felt by the sheet or by the yard, and remnant tables with cut fabric.
- **Discount stores:** felt sheets are often very cheap, around $0.25 to $1 each.
- **Online marketplaces:** bundles of 20 to 100 felt sheets in many colors.
- **Second-hand:** old clothes, scarves, napkins and sheets make beautiful, free linings.

Saving tips

- A small bag needs only one or two sheets of felt. Do not buy more than you need.
- Choose a neutral lining color that works with many bags, such as cream, black or navy.
- Use the same piece of fabric to make a small inner pocket.

7. Glue and Adhesives

What to look for

- A flexible craft or fabric glue that dries clear and holds felt to plastic.
- A tube with a fine tip, so you can put glue exactly where you need it.
- Fast grab, so you do not hold the lining in place for minutes.

- Glue that is safe for crafts and says so on the label. Use it in a room with fresh air.

Where to buy

- **Large craft stores:** several brands of fabric and craft glue. Look at the label for use on felt and plastic.
- **Discount stores:** small tubes are cheap, but test one on a scrap of felt and canvas before the real bag.
- **Online marketplaces:** multi-packs lower the price per tube.
- **Small wholesalers:** larger bottles with a refill tip are cheapest per ounce if you make many bags.

Saving tips

- A thin zigzag line of glue holds better than a thick blob, and uses less.
- Keep the cap on tight and store the tube upright.
- Do not buy a big bottle until you know you will make more than a few bags.

Where to Look, Region by Region

These tables show types of places to check, plus general chains and platforms that many readers already know. They are examples, not a promise that a shop is open near you. Availability changes: check what is open near you.

United States

MATERIAL	TYPES OF PLACES TO CHECK	EXAMPLES TO LOOK FOR
Canvas and yarn	Big craft stores; mass retailers; online marketplaces	Michaels, Hobby Lobby, Walmart, Amazon
Needles and glue	Craft stores; discount stores	Michaels, Walmart, Dollar Tree
Chains, clasps, rings	Online marketplaces; bag-making suppliers; second-hand	Amazon, Etsy, eBay, thrift stores
Felt and fabric	Discount stores; fabric stores; thrift stores	Dollar Tree, Walmart, local fabric shops

United Kingdom

MATERIAL	TYPES OF PLACES TO CHECK	EXAMPLES TO LOOK FOR
Canvas and yarn	Craft chains; haberdashery shops; online marketplaces	Hobbycraft, Amazon, eBay
Needles and glue	Craft stores; pound shops	Hobbycraft, pound-shop chains
Chains, clasps, rings	Online marketplaces; second-hand	Etsy, eBay, charity shops
Felt and fabric	Fabric stores; charity shops; markets	Local fabric stores, charity shops

Canada

MATERIAL	TYPES OF PLACES TO CHECK	EXAMPLES TO LOOK FOR
Canvas and yarn	Craft stores; mass retailers; online marketplaces	Michaels, Walmart, Amazon
Needles and glue	Craft stores; dollar stores	Michaels, Dollarama
Chains, clasps, rings	Online marketplaces; second-hand	Etsy, eBay, thrift stores
Felt and fabric	Fabric stores; thrift stores	Local fabric stores, thrift shops

Australia

MATERIAL	TYPES OF PLACES TO CHECK	EXAMPLES TO LOOK FOR
Canvas and yarn	Craft and fabric chains; mass retailers; online marketplaces	Spotlight, Kmart, Amazon
Needles and glue	Craft stores; discount stores	Spotlight, Kmart
Chains, clasps, rings	Online marketplaces; second-hand	eBay, Etsy, op shops
Felt and fabric	Fabric chains; op shops	Spotlight, op shops

Other Countries

Wherever you live, look for the same five types of places: a large craft or haberdashery shop, a discount or variety store, an online marketplace that ships to your country, a bulk or wholesale seller, and a second-hand or recycling shop. Search in your own language for the words 'plastic canvas', 'needlepoint canvas' or 'craft yarn' and compare.

- **Large online marketplaces** such as Amazon, eBay and Etsy ship to many countries. Check shipping and import costs before you pay.
- **Local market stalls and fabric streets** in many cities sell yarn, felt and hardware by the piece at low prices.
- **Community groups** on Facebook Marketplace or similar sites often sell leftover craft supplies from people who stopped crafting.
- **Haberdashery and button shops** are great for clasps, rings and small metal parts.

> **Tip**
>
> If one material is hard to find where you live, ask a nearby friend to order extra when she shops online, or ask a local craft group where they buy canvas. Someone almost always knows.

Buying in Bulk and Splitting Orders

Packs of 10 or 50 pieces cost much less per piece. But you do not need 50 clasps for your first bags. That is where friends come in.

1. Find a pack with a lower price per piece than the single item.
2. Ask two or three friends who also want to start. A group chat works well.
3. Agree on who orders and who pays. The person who orders keeps the receipt.
4. Each person pays her fair share, including shipping, before the order is placed.
5. When it arrives, divide it right away, counting each pile twice.

> **Keep it fair**
>
> Write down what each person paid and what she received. A simple note on your phone avoids misunderstandings and keeps the friendship.

Bulk buying makes sense for things you use in every bag: canvas sheets, felt, glue and matching hardware. It does not make sense for colors of yarn you are not sure about. Buy those one or two skeins at a time.

Recycle Hardware from Old Bags

Old handbags, wallets, belts and even jackets hold free chains, clasps, D-rings and zippers. Ask family and friends for bags they no longer use, or look in thrift and charity shops.

1. Pick bags with solid metal hardware that is not bent, rusty or peeling.
2. Open the stitching around the hardware with a small seam ripper, a few stitches at a time.
3. Take off the clasp or chain and keep all small parts, such as the back plate and the washers.
4. Wash the metal in warm soapy water, rinse and dry fully.
5. Polish gently with a soft cloth. A drop of mild oil on a stuck twist lock often loosens it.
6. Test the clasp ten times before you use it on a new bag.

> **Safety**
>
> Seam rippers and tools are sharp. Work slowly, in good light, and keep the cutting edge pointing away from your fingers.

A good second-hand bag can give you two hardware sets for a couple of dollars. Keep your recycled parts sorted in small bags labeled by type and finish.

How to Judge an Online Seller

Online shopping saves money, but only if the package matches the listing. Take two minutes to check each seller.

BEFORE YOU PRESS BUY

- [ ] The seller has many reviews, not just a few. Read some of the lower ones to see the real problems.
- [ ] Reviews include photos from buyers, not only perfect product images.
- [ ] The listing shows real photos from several angles, with a size in inches.
- [ ] The product description says 7-count for canvas and 100% acrylic worsted for yarn.
- [ ] The return policy is clear and you can return it if it is wrong.
- [ ] The total price includes shipping and any taxes or fees.
- [ ] The estimated delivery time is reasonable for you.
- [ ] The seller answers questions politely if you message before ordering.
- [ ] You can pay in a way that protects the buyer, such as the platform's own payment system.

> **Red flags**
> Very low prices with no reviews, photos that look copied from elsewhere, vague sizes, and sellers who ask you to pay outside the platform. Skip them.

For your first order from any seller, buy a small amount. If everything is good, buy more next time.

Shopping Plan for Your First 4 Bags

Here is an example plan for four small bags in a mix of colors. Every number is a rough estimate. Prices vary by shop, and you may already own some items.

ITEM	AMOUNT FOR 4 SMALL BAGS	ROUGH COST
7-count plastic canvas	4 to 6 sheets	around $3 to $8
Worsted acrylic yarn	2 to 3 skeins in main colors, leftovers for details	around $4 to $10
Tapestry needles	1 small pack	around $2 to $4

ITEM	AMOUNT FOR 4 SMALL BAGS	ROUGH COST
Chain or handles	About 4 feet total, or recycled	around $0 to $6
Clasps, snaps and rings	4 sets, or recycled	around $0 to $6
Felt or lining fabric	4 to 6 sheets or scraps	around $1 to $4
Craft glue	1 tube	around $2 to $4

The total for all four bags is around $12 to $42 depending on how much you reuse. That is a wide range, and that is the point: the more you recycle and share, the closer you get to the $5 per small bag goal.

Your Order of Shopping

1. **Week 1:** Check your home and ask friends for yarn, felt and old bags. Write what you still need.
2. **Week 1:** Buy canvas, needles and glue at a craft or discount store, using a coupon if you can.
3. **Week 2:** Order hardware online or collect it from old bags. Choose one finish for all four bags.
4. **Week 2:** Buy yarn in the colors your first pattern needs. Do not buy extra colors yet.
5. **Week 3:** Make bag number one. Write down what you used and what was missing.
6. **Week 3 onward:** Fill the gaps before bags two, three and four.

> **Why order this way**
> Starting with the in-store items lets you stitch quickly while online hardware travels. You waste no time waiting.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- **Buying the wrong canvas count.** Always check it says 7-count. Other counts change the size of the bag.
- **Choosing the cheapest chain without looking at reviews.** A chain that breaks ruins a finished bag.
- **Forgetting shipping.** A cheap item with high shipping is not cheap.
- **Mixing metal finishes.** Gold and silver on one bag looks unplanned.
- **Buying too much yarn in one color before you know the pattern.** Start small.
- **Skipping the test.** Try glue, clasps and felt on a scrap before you use them on a finished bag.
- **Ordering from a seller with no reviews.** Wait, or order a small amount first.
- **Throwing away leftovers.** Leftover yarn and canvas are free supplies for your next bag.

- **Ignoring the time you spend shopping.** If a trip saves you $1 but takes an hour, it may not be worth it. Combine errands.

> **Reminder**
>
> This guide is educational and shares general ideas about where to shop. It is not legal, tax or financial advice. Prices, shops and shipping rules change, so always check the details yourself before you buy.

Next Step

Open your materials list for your first pattern and mark each item with one of the five supplier types from this guide. Then check your home, ask two friends, and place your first small order this week. Your first bag is closer than you think.